

with larger companies for their web service needs, try and tuck into the much larger piece of the pie.

It is after all, the small businesses that cannot afford the expensive consultancy fees and the big budgets that corporates have. This means that between the big fish that spend big money and the small fry that can't afford anything at all, there are millions of businesses (hundreds in your own neighbourhood), who would want to spend a little on setting up a web presence, and moving their services into the tech-savvy world of today.

1.2 What can I do?

The first step towards making money has to be inflection. Most of us tend to be honest with ourselves, and know what we're good at and aren't. That is, of course, notwithstanding delusions of grandeur.

As long time Digit readers will vouch for, the simplest way to judge your skills is to judge your interests. If you have a stack of Digit magazines and Fast Track books lying about, pick them up and scan them and try and make a mental map of what interests you. If you don't have this valuable stack handy, go to our online store at thinkdigit.com and look at the older issues, or ask some of our older forum members to share PDF versions of our older issues. Once you have a better understanding of your interests, you should now have a pointer towards the direction your skills are leaning in. It's not a sure-fire way, but it's a good start. For those of you who already know your skills, the hardest part is going to be to accept your weaknesses. For instance, we've known some of the best coders in the business to have some of the worst English language skills on Earth!

There are always ways to circumvent your weaknesses, of course, and the simplest is to find a friend who's the opposite. If you have a certain friend who comes to you for your help in all tech matters, but who you have to ask for help when dealing with complicated work proposals or basically anything to do with writing in English, then perhaps it makes sense to pitch this idea to him or her, and form a team. Although the idea of sharing profits, even before you've got a concrete plan on how to make money, may not seem very sane, trust us, it's better for you in the long run. Also, since there are costs associated with setting up a business, you might find that sharing the expenses with partners to be more desirable.

And in no way does this team building need to stop there. The aim here is simple, and the goal pretty much the same as those that some of the biggest companies around had when they were started – get diversity in skills and try and build a strong company. For instance, some of us have the gift of the gab, while some just don't. The problem is, with any business that's based on a service model, marketing your team's technology skills is often the most important skill of all...